School Closure Report

Woodmere Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

Dr. Jon Franco, Senior Chief of Operations
Margaret Calvert, Executive Director of School Planning and Modernization
501 N Dixon, Portland, OR 97227 | 503-916-2000

1. School Profile

School Name
Woodmere Elementary School

Administrator
Katherine Polizos

Location
7900 SE Duke St, Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Woodmere Elementary School is a K–5 neighborhood school in Southeast Portland's Brentwood-Darlington neighborhood. The school employs varied teaching approaches, scheduled early reading and mathematics intervention, and support through special education, English language instruction, and Talented and Gifted services, as well as Communication Behavior classrooms. Woodmere is a single-story campus, built in 1954, with 19 regular classrooms and four modular classrooms. Approximately 220 students are enrolled at Woodmere for the 2026-2027 school year.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2028-2029 school year is: $23,201. (This is calculated using projected FY28 compensation levels and current staffing practices, which could change in the near future due to budget uncertainty.)

If the school is closed in 2028, the projected overall savings is $1,100,925. This includes savings from administrative, custodial, and office staffing, 80% of utilities, and includes the one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

To accommodate the students who live more than one mile from Whitman, PPS anticipates increasing service to Whitman from one bus to two buses. The Transportation Department estimates an additional annual savings of approximately $110,000. The proposed change would reduce the total number of buses serving the closing and receiving schools, resulting in transportation cost savings.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	224	222	223	217	225

History of Requested and Actual Transfers
During the 2024-2025, 2025-2026, and 2026-2027 school years, 44 students requested transfers into Woodmere and 26 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 162 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools, and 53 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer.

Projected declining enrollment will make it difficult to maintain stable staffing, full programming, and essential student support services. Under enrollment-based staffing allocations, low enrollment can result in year-to-year staffing changes, blended-grade classrooms or combined programs, and reduced access to enrichment and student support offerings. Staff may serve multiple roles or split time across schools, limiting continuity and availability. While educators would continue working to meet students' needs, projected enrollment would constrain the school's ability to provide consistent access to a well-rounded educational experience without ongoing supplemental district resources.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built	Building size	Stories	Acres
1954	51,900 sq ft	1	5.53
Building condition	**Gross capacity**	**Functional capacity**	**Cost of school operations**
Poor; FCI 0.21	648 students	465 students	$5,150,541

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs
Woodmere is a single-story, H-shaped wood-frame school with red brick cladding, gable roofs, and an interior garden. While a recent roof replacement is near completion through the 2025 bond program, other facility assessments have identified aging mechanical and plumbing systems; signage identifying asbestos-containing pipe and equipment insulation; and approximately 85% of electrical distribution panels beyond design life.

ADA Accessibility
Woodmere is a single story building with accessible entrances.

Building Use
Woodmere houses a K–5 neighborhood school and Communication Behavior classrooms, with academic intervention, language learning, special education, and student support services.

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition
Following closure, potential uses of the Woodmere facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Woodmere would shift its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Whitman. Special Education students receiving Learning Center support would move to Whitman K-5 and join their Inclusive School Community. Special Education CB students would either move to a CB class at Kelly K-5 or move with their general education peers to Whitman K-5 and join their Inclusive School Community - this will be determined on a case-by-case basis.

Proposed Attendance Boundary
See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers
Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional bussing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Whitman has 24 classrooms and a functional capacity of 416 students. With a combined enrollment of 444, Whitman will likely need to re-evaluate the three classrooms dedicated to early childhood to be able to accommodate the reassigned students and provide designated flexible learning spaces for students with disabilities.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Woodmere Elementary School for the 2028–2029 school year, assigning its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Whitman, and also relocating the Communication Behavior classrooms to Whitman.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?
In the 2026-2027 school year PPS staffs and supports 56 elementary programs across the district. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. The enrollment of these programs ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of “well-resourced schools” as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can stabilize and offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. Given our current and projected budget shortfalls, we can no longer sustain subsidies for underenrolled sites. As a result, elementary schools have already faced several programmatic and operational constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Staffing for instructional coaching, academic coaching, and school climate support positions have been reduced;
- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;
- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;
- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in the 2027-2028 school year.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Whitman within the Franklin cluster. Enrollment at Whitman is projected to change from 192 to 444 in 2028. Based on projections, there will be two to three classrooms at each grade level. Whitman would require minimal upgrades to the kitchen (a warming cabinet). Classroom assignments, student support spaces, and use of shared areas would be coordinated to accommodate incoming students while supporting students already enrolled. As noted above, Whitman and the Early Learners team will likely need to re-evaluate the three classroom dedicated to the PPS Pre-K program to be able to accommodate the reassigned students

Woodmere is located approximately 0.7 mile from Whitman Elementary School. Nearby community resources include Flavel Park and Brentwood-Darlington Community Center, with Holgate Library serving the broader area. The proposed change would shift students' daily school activities toward Whitman and Flavel Park. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for eligible students. Potential barriers include longer walking distances and crossings of SE Flavel Street and other busy streets, depending on students' home addresses. PPS would support school bus service for students who live more than one mile from the school and work with the school community and the district Safe Routes to School coordinator to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Woodmere does not have Racial Equity & Social Justice (RESJ) partner programming. Closure is not expected to affect RESJ partner services. PPS will continue working with building leaders and school communities at receiving schools so that partnerships reflect what students and families need. Future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

Woodmere does not partner with a child care provider, as there has not been an identified need for on-site child care within its school community. Therefore, closure would not directly affect an existing child care partnership or require the relocation of a program. However, community needs may change over time, and we remain open to reassessing family demand and exploring partnerships with qualified child care providers if a need emerges. Any future program would require consideration of available space, licensing, staffing, and operational resources. We encourage the district to remain open to future opportunities to establish on-site child care if demand increases, ensuring that students and families have access to this important resource when needed.

Woodmere partners with Impact NW to operate its SUN Community School, providing community-based services and wraparound family supports through collaboration among PPS, Multnomah County, and the City of Portland. SUN provides free extended-day enrichment opportunities, access to food resources, educational support, family engagement opportunities,

and connections to social, health, and mental health resources. Additional services specific to Woodmere include a weekly family food backpack program providing groceries for entire households, parent and family cafés connecting families with school staff and social work supports, community events and resource fairs, and assistance navigating basic-needs resources. These services create an established connection point for students and families to access educational enrichment, food assistance, family support, and community resources. Closure could affect student and family access to these services, disrupt established relationships with SUN staff and community partners, and require adjustments to programming locations and service delivery.

Opportunities for partnerships to continue include transitioning students and services to Whitman, which also operates an Impact NW-led SUN Community School. Having the same community-based organization operating SUN at both schools creates an opportunity to maintain service continuity, preserve established relationships, coordinate family transitions, and potentially integrate existing programming and partnerships into Whitman's service delivery model.

Services requiring further coordination include assessing Whitman's capacity to accommodate additional students and families, maintaining access to food assistance and the family backpack program, coordinating family engagement and resource navigation supports, and identifying opportunities to continue existing enrichment programming and community partnerships.

Additional community impacts include potential disruptions to food access, family engagement, and trusted relationships with school-based support staff, as well as increased demand on Whitman's existing SUN resources. Proposed responses include coordinating with Impact NW and Whitman school leadership to develop a transition plan, assess staffing and program capacity, identify opportunities to maintain Woodmere's existing services and partnerships, transfer family referrals and support needs, and communicate alternative access points for families relying on SUN resources. Particular consideration should be given to maintaining access to food assistance and ensuring families experience a seamless transition into Whitman's existing community-based service system. Future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in the 2028-2029 school year, with students assigned to Whitman under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2028	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share Principal assignments with communities.

Timeline*	Action
February 2028	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2028	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2028	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.
May 2028	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2028	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2028	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2028	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2028	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

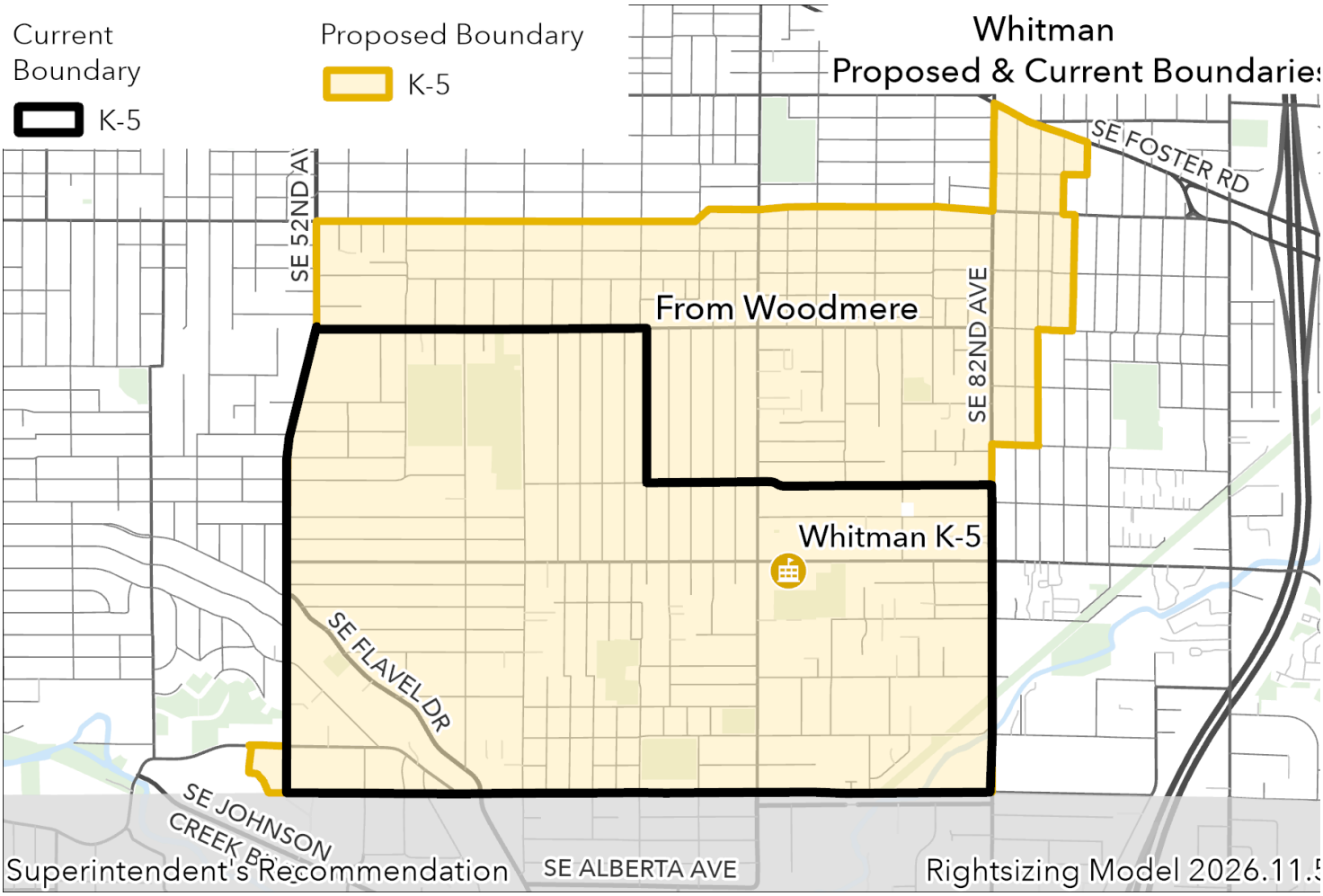
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date


Current Boundary
K-5
Proposed Boundary
K-5
Whitman
Proposed & Current Boundaries
SE FOSTER RD
SE 52ND AV
From Woodmere
SE 82ND AVE
Whitman K-5
SE FLAVEL DR
SE JOHNSON CREEK BL
SE ALBERTA AVE
Superintendent's Recommendation
Rightsizing Model 2026.11.5